DRAFT: GS Automation Team Expectations – QA Playbook

Page is about?

*Purpose: To align all automation engineers (SDETs) on clear expectations for ownership, deliverables, and responsibilities in the GS QA Automation Team, especially with regards to **regression testing**, **automation delivery**, and **continuous quality assurance**.*

Team Mission

Build and maintain a **reliable, scalable, and continuously improving automation framework** that ensures every product release is **traceable**, **stable**, and **free of escaped defects**, across **Universal Platform (UE)**, **Legacy Systems**, and **Plan Conversions**.

Core Expectations from Every Team Member

Regression Test Ownership

- Every engineer must contribute to and maintain regression coverage for their domain.
- Regression = new feature validation + backward compatibility checks.
- Test cases MUST be added to **qTest** for traceability.
- Regression suite must be **run, updated, and validated** before every release.

Feature Coverage Requirements

- All feature changes (IDP login, Enrollment, etc.) must be tied to **qTest test cases** and **JIRA Epics**.
- No code changes should be merged without test coverage and documentation.

Best Practice Compliance

- Follow Automation Best Practices & Folder Naming Standards.
- Use naming conventions for classes, methods, test case files, and locators.
- Practice DRY coding, proper error handling, and logging.
- Ensure tests are data-driven and environment-agnostic.

Phase 1 Priority Areas (from Henry)

The following areas are **Phase 1 Automation Must-Haves** and will be broken into qTest folders and JIRA Epics:

Feature	Description	qTest Module	Epic Status
IDP Login	IDP authentication login	`IDP/Login`	Created
Web Registration	General registration via web	`Registration/Web`	Created
Legacy Login (NY)	Legacy login for NY plan	`Legacy/Login-NY`	Created
Balance Page	Account balance access	`Account/Balance`	Created
Make a Contribution	Flow for making contributions	`Account/Contributions`	Created
Web Withdrawal	Withdrawal flow	`Account/Withdrawals`	Created
NY Legacy Enrollment	NY plan legacy flow	`Enrollment/NYLegacy`	Created
Account Info Update	Updating user profile	`Account/Updates`	Created

> ***Action:*** *Break each area into positive, negative, and boundary scenarios in qTest. Add traceability to JIRA stories/tasks.*

Monthly & Quarterly Goals

Cycle	Deliverable	Notes
Monthly	1 regression cycle with defect triage report	Includes coverage %, failure rate, RCA
Quarterly	Expand regression suite by 20% minimum	Retire outdated tests, add new flags
Monthly	Report test automation metrics to leadership	# of runs, pass %, top defects

Sprint (Bi-weekly)	New feature automation & peer review	Linked to current sprint scope

Tooling & Process Checklist

Area	Tool	Notes
Test Management	qTest	Test case repo, traceability
Defect Logging	JIRA	Bugs, escaped defect reporting
CI Execution	Jenkins	Triggered via GitLab pipelines
Framework	PRIME v3 (Cucumber + TestNG)	Data-driven & modular
Metrics Dashboard	JIRA & qTest Reports	Used for release readiness

Defect Reporting Email Template

> ***To:*** *Dev Lead, QA Manager*
> ***Subject:*** *[BLOCKER] Defect in {Feature Name} – {Short Summary}*
>
> *Hi Team,*
>
> *A defect has been identified in the `{feature name}` module during `{test phase}`.*
>
> ***Environment:*** *QA / Stage*
> ***JIRA:*** *QA-12345 [Add Jira Link]*
> ***Steps to Reproduce:***
>
> 1. *Step 1*
> 2. *Step 2*
> 3. *...*
>
> ***Expected Result:*** *{Expected output}*
> ***Actual Result:*** *{Bug or issue observed}*
>
> ***Attachments:*** *Logs, screenshot, error message*
>
> *Please triage at the earliest.*
>
> *Regards,*
> Your Name

Jira Setup Suggestions

Each **Epic** should include:

- Linked qTest folder/module
- Checklists for:
  - Feature automation completed
  - Regression cases validated
  - Defect retest & RCA done
- Subtasks for:
  - Automation development
  - Manual review (if applicable)
  - Code + test review
  - CI pipeline verification

How Success Is Measured

Metric	Goal
Escaped Defects	< 2 per release
Automation Coverage	> 80% per module
Regression SLA	1 full cycle per sprint

RCA Time	< 24 hrs
Test Stability	< 3% flakiness
qTest-JIRA Traceability	100%

OA Automation Jira Board